



My Friend Jesus

Requirements

1. Listen to a book about Jesus.
2. Sing a song about Jesus.
3. Play a game about Jesus.
4. Learn how Jesus grew up helping/obeying his parents.
5. Learn to be friends with peers as Jesus was
6. Make a friend craft.

Supporting Answers

1. There are many books about Jesus. The important thing is to choose one that meets the Little Lamb interest and vocabulary level.

Bible App for Kids is a ministry of Youversion Bible Inc. and provides nearly 50 interactive Bible stories for kids. There is an animated storybook app with vivid illustrations and sound as well as interactive touch screen interactions. The games and activities help kids remember what they learn. The navigation is simple for kids and there are no in-app purchases. There is also a printed Bible that has the same stories and graphics. See your device's app store.

Bibleforchildren.org has illustrated and color pages for sixty different Bible stories available for download and printing in 132 different languages. There are 18 stories about Jesus (including Powerpoint, coloring pages, and storybook pages) <http://bibleforchildren.org/> or your device's App store.

2. Idea: To the tune London Bridge is Falling Down)

Jesus is my friend today, Clap your hands, Shout hurray Jesus is my friend today, We love Jesus.

Jesus is my friend today, Stomp your Feet, Shout hurray Jesus is my friend today, We love Jesus.

Jesus is my friend today, Turn around, Shout hurray Jesus is my friend today, We love Jesus.

A group can even do motions with this. Jesus (pointer fingers at alternating palms), is my friend today (hug self), Stomp your feet (stomp your feet), Shout hurray (shout hurray), Jesus (pointer fingers at alternating palms), is my friend today (hug self), We (flat hand touch right shoulder and arc to left shoulder, love (draw heart over heart), Jesus (pointer fingers at alternating palms).

Other song titles include:

"Jesus Loves Me"

"You are my All"

"Jesus' Love is a Bubblin' Over"

Use your favorite search engine: kids songs my friend Jesus.

3. Several simple games could be used:

Idea: adults cut out hearts and write "Jesus loves you," "God is love," "Jesus is my friend," "Jesus loves children," and other similar messages. Hearts are hidden around the room. Each child can run to go find one. Instruct children that if they find more than one, leave it where it is and HELP a friend find a "Jesus friend heart."

4. There is very little information in the Bible about Jesus' growing up years. Luke 2:51-52 is the summary of how Jesus helped and obeyed his parents. The New International Version states:

"Then Jesus ... was obedient to them. ... And Jesus grew in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and man."

The children could be taught the words with hand motions.

Jesus (pointer fingers point to opposite alternating palms)

was obedient to them (nodding head in agreement)

and he grew in wisdom (tap forehead with first finger)

and stature (palm starts at hip, palm flat and facing down. Then "grow" it upward to the shoulder)

and in favor (clap hands twice)

with God (flat palm, fingers pointed up, palm towards center, palm descends across center face line) and mankind. (first finger points towards other people)

The goal is to learn that Jesus obeyed his parents, learned, and grew physically. There are a number of children's story books that have beautiful illustrations that show his growing process and use age appropriate language.

5. This is a good discussion requirement that gives children a chance to think about how to treat others their own age (peers). Adult leaders can ask questions to a small group such as: "How do I like to be treated by other children?" "When a friend has a toy that I would like to play with, how do I act like Jesus?" "When a friend takes something from me, what would Jesus like me to do?"

Parent-supported role-playing is very good with this age group, especially if adults role play the scenarios first, then have children copy them. ALWAYS use situations where love and respect for each other is displayed. Remember that many in this group are still developmentally "solo players," meaning that they don't know HOW to play WITH other children, but only how to play alongside other children. Patience with them as they learn a new developmental skill is important!

6. The Activity guide can help you with this game, or you can search online for "Jesus love children craft."